Selected Research 2021-2025

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Me by the numbers

- 2 advanced degrees (University of Chicago)
- 2 countries
- 4 global cities
- 4 major international multi-year research projects
- 4 languages

Research Highlights

- JP Morgan headquarters physical technology design
- JP Morgan global office hardware, service and software design
- Senegalese data, IP, and privacy law
- Data and restriction of information flows as value generators in globally regulated industry
- Applications of HR data

Project deep dive: Process Improvement Research & App Design

How do we modernize a manual process tied to multiple legacy software systems to keep up with demand at a 300k+ employee Fortune 500?

The Context

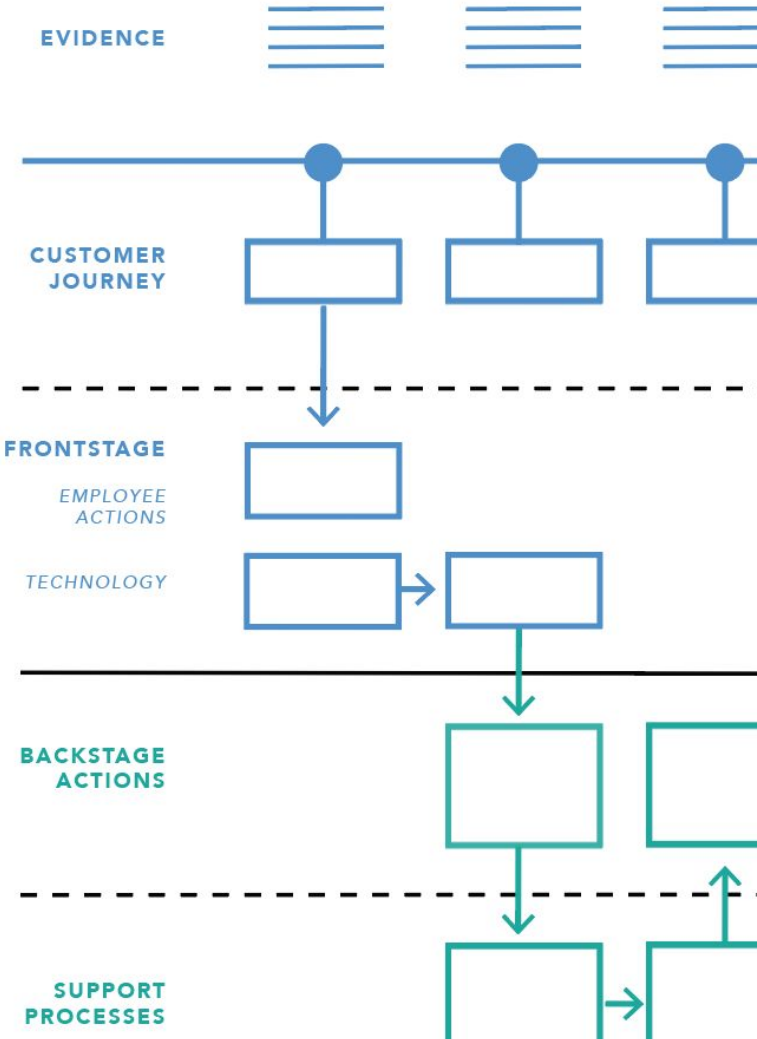
- 20,000+ events per year
- Technical production staff manages lights, sound, live streaming, accommodations (e.g. live captioning) etc.
- 30 and 90 minutes of manual tasks per event
- Manual copy/paste between 6 different legacy applications
- New tool must integrate existing systems
- Bonus: a process map

Research approach

- Interviews & observation with 8 technical producers
- Heuristic evaluation
- Usability interviews with 14 event planners

Interim deliverables

- Current state process map
- Future state service blueprint
- Executive presentation
- Wireframes
- Presentations with engineers, product: requirements and user stories



Additional research

- Rapid iterative testing
  - 8 producers
  - 8 event planners

Impact

- Reduced number of applications from 6 to 1
- Streamlined communications between producers & planners
- 30 to 90 mins per event of administrative labor eliminated
- >$1.5 million/year in cost savings

Retrospective

- Did well: Follow the process
- Wish I'd done: Involve engineering early on
- What I'd do with no constraints: Continued testing throughout development process

Research Deep Dive: The JP Morgan Lobby Physical, Digital, Operational Design

What user experience considerations should we keep in mind when designing the building lobby and all technologies needed to navigate it?

The Context

- Employees
  - Local
  - Visiting
- Guests
  - Clients
  - Event attendees
  - Vendors/partners
  - Family/friends
- Deliveries
- High security demands
- Arts experience
- Public

Physical Design:
The pandemic-safe research approach (2020-21)

- Power user interviews & remote observation
  - Security
  - Front desk
  - Event planners
  - VIP hosts
- Accessibility evaluation
- Collaboration with architects to understand foot traffic analysis and architectural studies

Physical Design: The RTO research approach (2022)

- Diary study
  - HQ employee
  - Visitor hosts
- Contextual inquiry
  - Commute ride alongs
  - Front desk shadowing
  - General lobby observations

Digital and Operational Orchestration

- Stakeholder workshops coordinating known user needs (from this and other studies conducted in interim) existing digital systems, operational needs.
- Service blueprint creation
- User stories for individual new and revamped applications
- Mobile hardware recommendations for seamless untethered operations

Analysis & Output

- Data coding
- Findings
- Entry flows
- Software user needs (legacy, web based, mobile)
- Process maps
- Service blueprints coordinating all aspects
- Software testing (RITE)

Findings & recommendations

- Lobby + loading dock
- Lobby lines
- Lobby staff room
- Secure access technology and process
- Guest management software revamp
- Guest management process with augmented mobile capability

Retrospective

- Did well: Data recycling
- Wish I'd done: Consider additional audience segments from the beginning, gain broad stakeholder involvement for multiple workshops beginning in 2019
- What I'd do with no constraints: Gather greater first person data, more testing at wireframe stage

Press

- “At JPMorgan's new HQ, the tech knows who you are — and how you take your coffee” Business Insider
- “Employees entering the tower will use biometric palm scanners in place of traditional ID cards, reflecting the banking sector’s shift toward secure and frictionless authentication. Alongside the hardware, JPMorgan has launched the “Work at JPMC” mobile app, which serves as a digital badge and central hub for employee services. Through the app, staff can manage guest registration, navigate indoor maps, and pre-order meals from the building’s 19 on-site dining vendors. The app also integrates with workplace systems to manage conference room registrations and personal preferences, supporting flexible collaboration.” - IDTechWire

Questions?